

LIVE

Learning Space

NEWSPAPER

20th February, 2018

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

8th WEEK



SHADOW OVER TRUDEAU VISIT

**UPSC CSE –
GS II**

GS II ... BILATERAL, REGIONAL AND GLOBAL GROUPINGS AND AGREEMENTS INVOLVING INDIA AND/OR AFFECTING INDIA'S INTERESTS.

5

Canadian bathos: Trudeau's vote-banks

His indulgence towards Sikh separatists
threatens the bilateral
relationship with India



THAT DOMESTIC politics often trumps the enlightened pursuit of national interest abroad is not news. In most countries, especially democracies, the cultivation of narrowly-based domestic constituencies for electoral reasons has its unfortunate consequences for the conduct of foreign policy.

Delhi's perennial focus on elections of one kind or another makes its leaders quite sensitive to the domestic political considerations of India's foreign interlocutors. But Delhi is struggling to make sense of Prime Minister Justin Trudeau's political indulgence of Sikh extremists in Canada. To be sure, Sikhs form a third of the Indian community in Canada of roughly 1.2 million or 3 per cent of Canadian population. That only a small section of Sikhs is hostile to Delhi makes Trudeau's approach truly baffling.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who is more than eager to send a visiting leader in his home state, Gujarat, did not travel to Ahmedabad to be with Trudeau on Monday. This underlines the new cooling that is enveloping the relationship.

On the face of it, the Canadian PM's visit is indeed a valuable opportunity to clear the air on Trudeau's attitude towards Sikh separatism. But it is not apparent at the writing of this column whether he is ready to affirm a strong commitment to the unity and territorial integrity of India and disavow himself from the Khalistanis. Trudeau's team has been sending conflicting signals even after he landed in India on Saturday.

Delhi is disappointed that despite its repeated efforts, including at the highest political levels, to flag the question of Sikh separatism in Canada, Ottawa has seemed reluctant to address India's concerns. Delhi, however, has rightly decided it must stay engaged with Trudeau, who leads one of the world's top economies and is a member of the Group of Seven advanced nations. But Delhi has good reasons to keep its fingers crossed.

It is entirely possible that Trudeau's visit, instead of putting aside the Khalistan issue, could end up aggravating the differences with India. Those with longer memories in Delhi worry that Trudeau's trip could turn out to be the worst diplomatic disaster in India since Queen Elizabeth's visit in 1997.

Although the Queen came to India to celebrate the 50th anniversary of independence, a series of incidents ruined the visit. As the Queen travelled to Pakistan before arriving in India, the foreign secretary of the Labour government, Robin Cook, told the then Prime Minister

Nawaz Sharif that London could help find a "just settlement" of the Kashmir dispute. At a moment when Jammu and Kashmir was on the boil, Delhi was provoked into an outrage.

Prime Minister Inder Kumar Gujral responded to the British offer to mediate by dismissing the United Kingdom a "third rate power". When the Queen visited Amritsar to lay a wreath at the memorial for the martyrs of the Jallianwala Bagh massacre, her husband Prince Philip was quoted as saying the number of deaths may have been "exaggerated". A scuffle with the Indian media on the tarmac, in the royal aircraft prepared to take off at the end of tour, wrapped up the troubled trip.

Two decades later, the Indian media is a much larger and far more challenging entity that can amplify even the smallest of Trudeau's missteps into a huge political controversy. Whether Trudeau's visit will help or harm bilateral relations is likely to be decided in Amritsar. Trudeau is scheduled to visit the Harmandir Sahib on Wednesday.

One would have thought that Trudeau's meeting with Punjab chief minister, Amarinder Singh, would send a clear political signal about Canada's rejection of Sikh extremism. After all, the Khalistanis have especially targeted Singh. But there have been conflicting signals from Canada on whether Trudeau wants to meet Singh or not. Over the weekend, Canadian media cited officials saying that Trudeau had no plans to meet with the CM. Later reports, and Singh himself have suggested the opposite. It seems that efforts to arrange a meeting between the two are ongoing.

It is indeed tragic that India-Canada relations have become a political hostage to the Khalistan question. What a fall from the exalted tradition of liberal internationalism that once bound Delhi and Ottawa. In the early years of the Cold War, India and Canada sought to create political breathing room for middle powers in a fraught bipolar world.

At the bilateral level, civil nuclear collaboration between the two countries was a shining example of scientific internationalism during the Cold War. India and Canada did fall out when Delhi conducted a nuclear test in 1974, but their bitter arguments were at least about the principles of non-proliferation.

It is a pity that Canada's vote-bank politics have grounded a relationship that was ready for take-off just before Trudeau's election. Modi and Trudeau's predecessors, Stephen Harper, had unveiled in 2015 a vision for strategic partnership that was to build on the many shared interests between the two countries. One can only hope that Trudeau and his team have the political will to put the partnership with India back on track and skill to navigate this difficult moment.

The writer is director, Carnegie India, Delhi and a contributing editor on foreign affairs for *The Indian Express*



The Indian EXPRESS
JOURNALISM OF COURAGE

20th February, 2018



5 Canadian bathos: Justin Trudeau's vote-banks

His indulgence towards Sikh separatists threatens the bilateral relationship with India.

That domestic politics often trumps the enlightened pursuit of national interest abroad is not news. In most countries, especially democracies, the cultivation of narrowly-based domestic constituencies for electoral reasons has its unfortunate consequences for the conduct of foreign policy.

Delhi's perennial focus on elections of one kind or another makes its leaders quite sensitive to the domestic political considerations of India's foreign interlocutors. But Delhi is struggling to make sense of Prime Minister Justin Trudeau's political indulgence of Sikh extremists in Canada. To be sure, Sikhs form a third of the Indian community in Canada of roughly 1.2 million or 3 per cent of Canadian population. That only a small section of Sikhs is hostile to Delhi makes Trudeau's approach truly baffling.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who is more than eager to serenade visiting leaders in his home state, Gujarat, did not travel to Ahmedabad to be with Trudeau on Monday. This underlines the new cooling that is enveloping the relationship. On the face of it, the Canadian PM's visit is indeed a valuable opportunity to clear the air on Trudeau's attitude towards Sikh separatism. But it is not apparent at the writing of this column whether he is ready to affirm a strong commitment to the unity and territorial integrity of India and dissociate himself from the Khalistanis. Trudeau's team has been sending conflicting signals even after he landed in India on Saturday. Delhi is disappointed that despite its repeated efforts, including at the highest political levels, to flag the question of Sikh separatism in Canada, Ottawa has seemed reluctant to address India's concerns. Delhi, however, has rightly decided it must stay engaged with Trudeau, who leads one of the world's top economies and is a member of the Group of Seven advanced nations. But Delhi has good reasons to keep its fingers crossed.

...Contd.



5 Canadian bathos: Justin Trudeau's vote-banks

It is entirely possible that Trudeau's visit, instead of putting aside the Khalistan issue, could end up aggravating the differences with India. Those with longer memories in Delhi worry that Trudeau's trip could turn out to be the worst diplomatic disaster in India since Queen Elizabeth's visit in 1997.

Although the Queen came to India to celebrate the 50th anniversary of Independence, a series of incidents ruined the visit. As the Queen travelled to Pakistan before arriving in India, the foreign secretary of the Labour government, Robin Cook, told the then Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif that London could help find a "just settlement" of the Kashmir dispute. At a moment when Jammu and Kashmir was on the boil, Delhi was provoked into an outrage.

Prime Minister Inder Kumar Gujral responded to the British offer to mediate by dismissing the United Kingdom a "third rate power". When the Queen visited Amritsar to lay a wreath at the memorial for the martyrs of the Jallianwalla Bagh massacre, her husband Prince Philip was quoted as saying the the number of deaths may have been "exaggerated". A scuffle with the Indian media on the tarmac, as the royal aircraft prepared to take-off at the end of tour, wrapped up the troubled trip.

Two decades later, the Indian media is a much larger and far more challenging entity that can amplify even the smallest of Trudeau's missteps into a huge political controversy. Whether Trudeau's visit will help or harm bilateral relations is likely to be decided in Amritsar. Trudeau is scheduled to visit the Harmandir Sahib on Wednesday.

...Contd.



5 Canadian bathos: Justin Trudeau's vote-banks

One would have thought that Trudeau's meeting with Punjab chief minister, Amarinder Singh, would send a clear political signal about Canada's rejection of Sikh extremism. After all, the Khalistanis have especially targeted Singh. But there have been conflicting signals from Canada on whether Trudeau wants to meet Singh or not. Over the weekend, Canadian media cited officials saying that Trudeau had no plans to meet with the CM. Later reports, and Singh himself have suggested the opposite. It seems that efforts to arrange a meeting between the two are ongoing.

It is indeed tragic that India-Canada relations have become a political hostage to the Khalistan question. What a fall from the exalted tradition of liberal internationalism that once bound Delhi and Ottawa. In the early years of the Cold War, India and Canada sought to create political breathing room for middle powers in a fraught bipolar world.

At the bilateral level, civil nuclear collaboration between the two countries was a shining example of scientific internationalism during the Cold War. India and Canada did fall out when Delhi conducted a nuclear test in 1974, but their bitter arguments were at least about the principles of non-proliferation.

It is a pity that Canada's vote-bank politics have grounded a relationship that was ready for take-off just before Trudeau's election. Modi and Trudeau's predecessor, Stephen Harper, had unveiled in 2015 a vision for strategic partnership that was to build on the many shared interests between the two countries. One can only hope that Trudeau and his team have the political will to put the partnership with India back on track and skill to navigate this difficult moment.

5

Canadian bathos: Trudeau's vote-banks

His indulgence towards Sikh separatists
threatens the bilateral
relationship with India



RAJA MANDALA
BY C. RAJA MOHAN

THAT DOMESTIC politics often trumps the enlightened pursuit of national interest abroad is not news. In most countries, especially democracies, the cultivation of narrowly-based domestic constituencies for electoral reasons has in the past often come at the cost of foreign policy.

Delhi's perennial focus on elections of one kind or another makes its leaders quite sensitive to the domestic political considerations of India's foreign interlocutors. But Delhi is struggling to make sense of Prime Minister Justin Trudeau's political indulgence of Sikh extremists in Canada. To be sure, Sikhs form a third of the Indian community in Canada of roughly 1.2 million or 1 per cent of Canadian population. That only a small section of Sikhs is hostile to Delhi makes Trudeau's approach truly baffling.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who is more than eager to make visiting leaders in his home state Gujarat, did not travel to Ahmedabad to be with Trudeau on Monday. This underlines the new cooling that is enveloping the relationship.

On the face of it, the Canadian PM's visit is indeed a valuable opportunity to clear the air on Trudeau's attitude towards Sikh separatism. But it is not apparent at the writing of this column whether he is ready to affirm a strong commitment to the unity and territorial integrity of India and disavow claims from the Khalistanis. Trudeau's visit has been sending conflicting signals even after he landed in India on Saturday.

Delhi is disappointed that despite its repeated efforts, including at the highest political levels, to flag the question of Sikh separatism in Canada, Ottawa has seemed reluctant to address India's concerns. Delhi, however, has rightly decided it must stay engaged with Trudeau, who leads one of the world's top economies and is a member of the Group of Seven advanced nations. But Delhi has good reasons to keep its fingers crossed.

It is entirely possible that Trudeau's visit, instead of putting aside the Khalistan issue, could end up aggravating the differences with India. Those with larger memories in Delhi worry that Trudeau's trip could turn out to be the worst diplomatic disaster in India since Queen Elizabeth's visit in 1983.

Although the Queen came to India to celebrate the 50th anniversary of independence, a series of incidents ruined the visit. As the Queen travelled to Pakistan before arriving in India, the foreign secretary of the Labour government, Robin Cook, told the then Prime Minister

Narasimha Murthy that London could help find a "just settlement" of the Kashmir dispute. At a moment when Jinnah and Kachru were on the hot, Delhi was provoked into an outrage.

Prime Minister Indira Kumar Ghandi responded to the British offer to mediate by dismissing the United Kingdom a "third-rate power". When the Queen visited Amritsar to lay a wreath at the memorial for the martyrs of the Jallianwala Bagh massacre, her husband Prince Philip was quoted as saying the number of deaths may have been "exaggerated". A scuffle with the Indian media on the tarmac, as the royal aircraft prepared to take off at the end of four, wrapped up the troubled trip.

Two decades later, the Indian media is a much larger and far more challenging entity that can amplify even the smallest of Trudeau's missteps into a huge political controversy. Whether Trudeau's visit will help or harm bilateral relations is likely to be decided in Amritsar. Trudeau is scheduled to visit the Harmandir Sahib on Wednesday.

One would have thought that Trudeau's meeting with Punjab Chief Minister Amarinder Singh, would send a clear political signal about Canada's rejection of Sikh extremism. After all, the Khalistanis have especially targeted Singh, that there have been conflicting signals from Canada on whether Trudeau wants to meet Singh or not. Over the weekend, Canadian media cited officials saying that Trudeau had no plans to meet with the CM. Later reports, and Singh himself have suggested the opposite. It seems that efforts to arrange a meeting between the two are ongoing.

A longstanding legacy that India-Canada relations have become a political hostage to the Khalistan question. What a fall from the ennobled tradition of liberal internationalism that once bound Delhi and Ottawa. In the early years of the Cold War, India and Canada sought to create political breathing room for middle powers in a fraught bipolar world.

At the bilateral level, civil nuclear collaboration between the two countries was a shining example of scientific internationalism during the Cold War. India and Canada did fall out when Delhi conducted a nuclear test in 1994, but their better arguments were at least about the principles of non-proliferation.

It is a pity that Canada's vote-bank politics have grounded a relationship that was ready for take-off just before Trudeau's election. Mulcair and Trudeau's predecessor Stephen Harper, had unveiled in 2015 a vision for strategic partnership that was to build on the many shared interests between the two countries. One can only hope that Trudeau and his team have the political will to put the partnership with India back on track and skill to navigate this difficult moment.

The writer is director, Carnegie India, Delhi and a contributing editor on foreign affairs for 'The Indian Express'.

The Indian EXPRESS, Tue, 20 February 2018
http://indianexpress.com/article/india/2018/02/20/

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... Bilateral, Regional and Global Groupings and Agreements involving India and/or Affecting India's Interests.



SIKHS AND CANADA

- 1 Sikhs form a third of the Indian community in Canada and are roughly 1.2 million or 3% of the Canadian population
- 2 Delhi is disappointed that despite its repeated efforts, the Sikh separatism in Canada is the main point of concern. Ottawa has seemed reluctant to address India's concerns.
- 3 New Delhi rightly decided to stay engaged with Justin Trudeau, who leads one of the world's top economies and is a member of the G7 Advanced Nations.



QUEEN ELIZABETH



NAWAZ SHARIF

HISTORY REPEATED AFTER 20 YEARS

POINT NO. 1 IN QUEEN'S VISIT IN 1997

- 1** Queen Elizabeth visited India in 1997. She came to India to celebrate the 50th anniversary of Independence.
- 2** Queen travelled to Pakistan before arriving in India and the Foreign Secretary told the then Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif that London could help find a "just settlement" of the Kashmir dispute. At that time, Jammu and Kashmir was on the boil.
- 3** The then Prime Minister Inder Kumar Gujral responded by dismissing United Kingdom a "third rated power".



UZBEKISTAN

KYRGYZSTAN

TURKMENISTAN

TAJIKISTAN

IRAN

AFGHANISTAN

PAKISTAN

NEPAL

INDIA

BANGLADESH

OMAN

Caspian Sea

Persian Gulf

Gulf of Oman

HISTORY REPEATED AFTER 20 YEARS

POINT NO. 2 IN QUEEN'S VISIT IN 1997



Queen Elizabeth visited Amritsar to lay a wreath at the memorial for the martyrs of the Jallianwala Bagh massacre and her husband Prince Philip was quoted as saying that the number of deaths may have been “exaggerated”.

INDIA CANADA RELATIONS ... POLITICAL HOSTAGE TO THE KHALISTAN ISSUE



- 1 In the early years of the Cold war, India and Canada sought to create political breathing room for middle powers in the Bipolar World
- 2 At the bilateral level, Nuclear Civil Cooperation between the two countries was a shining example of Scientific Internationalism during the Cold war.
- 3 However, they fell out, when Delhi conducted Nuclear Test in 1974, but their bitter arguments were at least about the principles of non-proliferation.



JUSTIN TRUDEAU
Prime Minister, Canada

*One can only hope that
Trudeau and his team has the
political will to put the
partnership with India back
on track and skill to navigate
the difficult moment.*

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

Amrita Naidu
D. Sunil Kumar
L. V. Krishna
D. Chaitanya

K. Srikanth
G. Ravi Babu
D. Joji
K. Victor Babu

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 - 2 4 4 4 4 7 2
0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9